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Deploy an Angular project to Vercel with secret environment variables



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Do you want to deploy your front-end Angular project on Vercel but hide your API keys from GitHub?

Certain data should not be posted on GitHub, such as a secret API key. When we work locally we put our API keys in the *environments* folder that we create with the `*ng generate environments*` command. This folder should not be uploaded to GitHub if we have confidential data in it.

The problem comes when deploying to Vercel because Vercel needs the *environments* folder for our app to work.

How can we do it then?

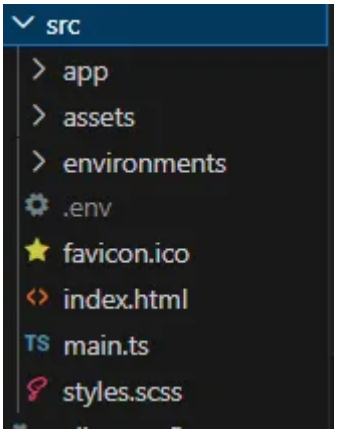
Vercel allows us to add Environment Variables. In a way, it helps us to create a *.env* file for deployment. However, before we can use this file with our Angular app, certain changes must be made to our code. We could say that from Angular's root folder itself, you can't access the .env file.

To solve this issue we are going to create a file called *mynode.js* outside the root folder. This JS file will access the *.env* file, collect its values, and populate our Angular *environments* file with them. This means that before Vercel builds the app, we will tell it to first fill our "empty" *environments* from GitHub with the data we have given it as Environment Variables.

To complete this process you have to follow the steps below:

1. **Create your Angular project**

2. **Create a *.env* file inside the source folder**



3. **Make sure your *.env* file is mentioned in your *.gitignore* file**



4. Complete your *.env* file in the following format

```
VARIABLE_NAME=variableValue
OTHER_VARIABLE_NAME=variableValue
```

- Remember not to put spaces before or after the equal, and to not put a comma at the end of the value.

5. Edit the *environments* folder as follows:

- *environments* > *environment.development.ts*

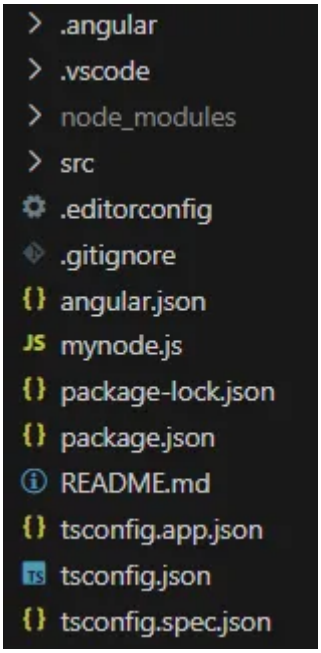
```
export const environment = {
  VARIABLE_NAME: '',
  OTHER_VARIABLE_NAME: '',
}
```

- *environments* > *environment.ts*

```
export const environment = {};
```

6. Install dotenv with *npm i dotenv*

7. Create a *mynode.js* file outside our *src* folder



8. Populate the *mynode.js* file with the following JavaScript code:

```
const fs = require('fs');
const path = require('path');
const successColor = '\x1b[32m%s\x1b[0m';
const checkSign = '\u{2705}';
const dotenv = require('dotenv').config({path: 'src/.env'}); ;

const envFile = `export const environment = {
    VARIABLE_NAME: '${process.env.VARIABLE_NAME}',
    OTHER_VARIABLE_NAME: '${process.env.OTHER_VARIABLE_NAME}',
};
`;
const targetPath = path.join(__dirname, './src/environments/environment.develop
fs.writeFile(targetPath, envFile, (err) => {
    if (err) {
        console.error(err);
        throw err;
    } else {
        console.log(successColor, `${checkSign} Successfully generated environm
```

```
    }
});
```

9. Head to the *package.json* file and change the value of scripts.start to *node -r dotenv/config mynode.js && ng serve.*



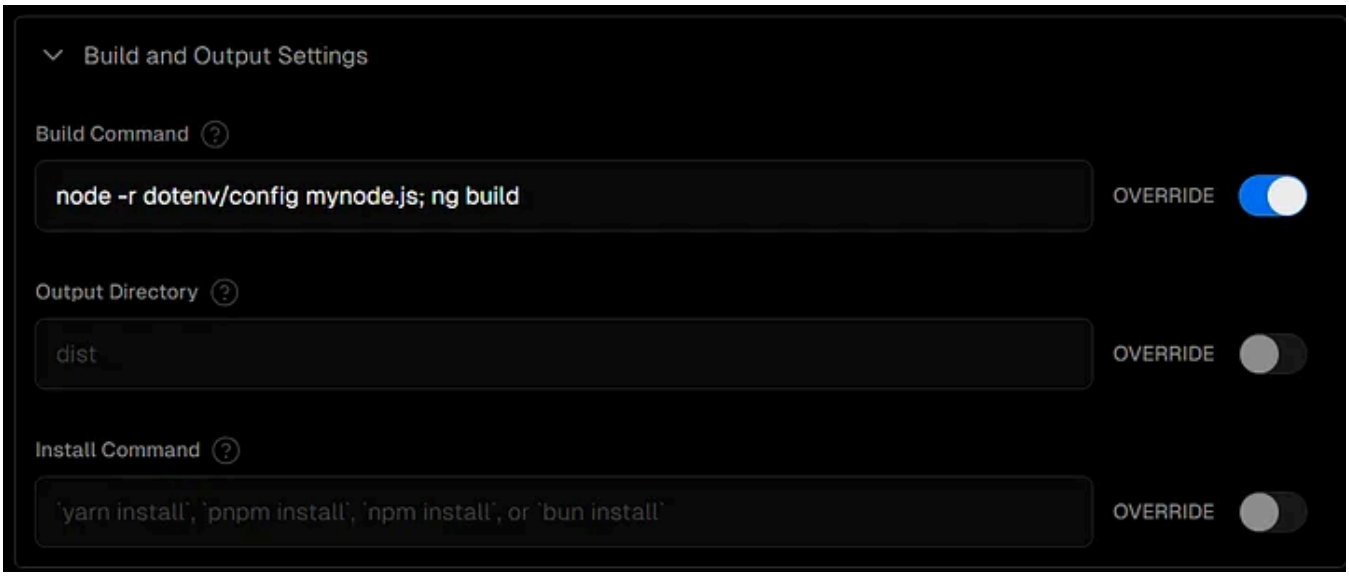
This change will make it so that we can run the app locally with the command *npm start*.

- *node -r dotenv/config mynode.js* — will run the *mynode.js* file.
- *ng serve* — will serve the Angular app.

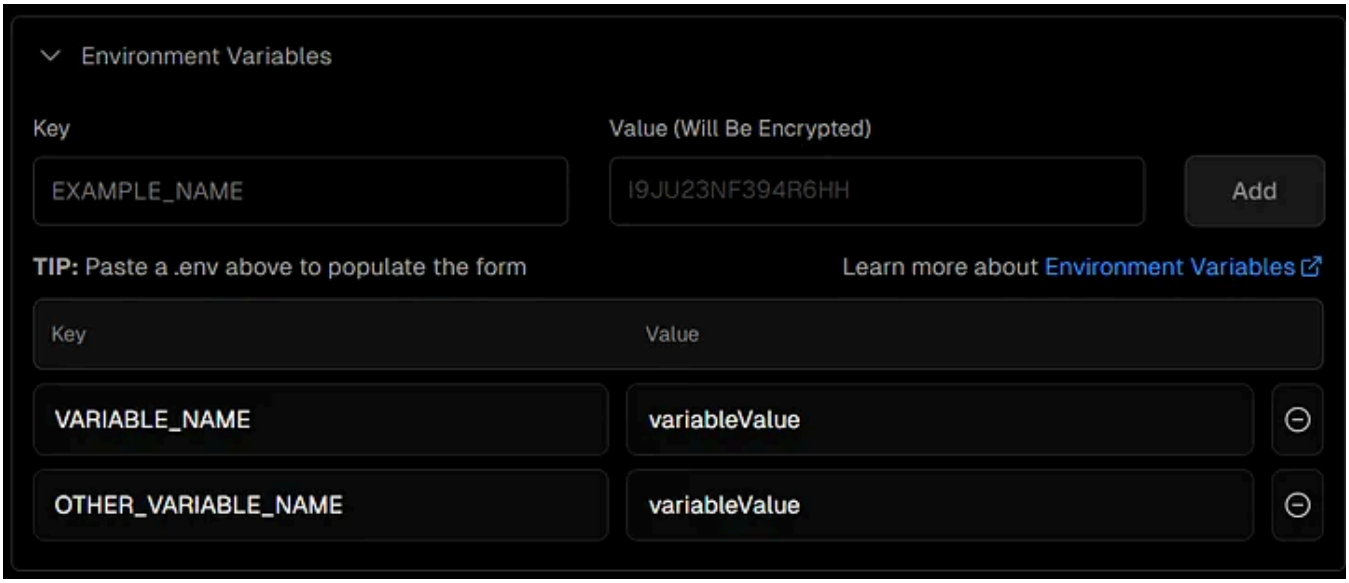
10. Head to Vercel
11. Import your repository from GitHub
12. Configure your project:

If you have already deployed your project, you can make the following edits in Settings.

- **Build and Output Settings** — set *node -r dotenv/config mynode.js; ng build* as out Build Command



- **Environment Variables —** set your environment variables



13. Deploy

Now your Angular project is deployed and ready to go!

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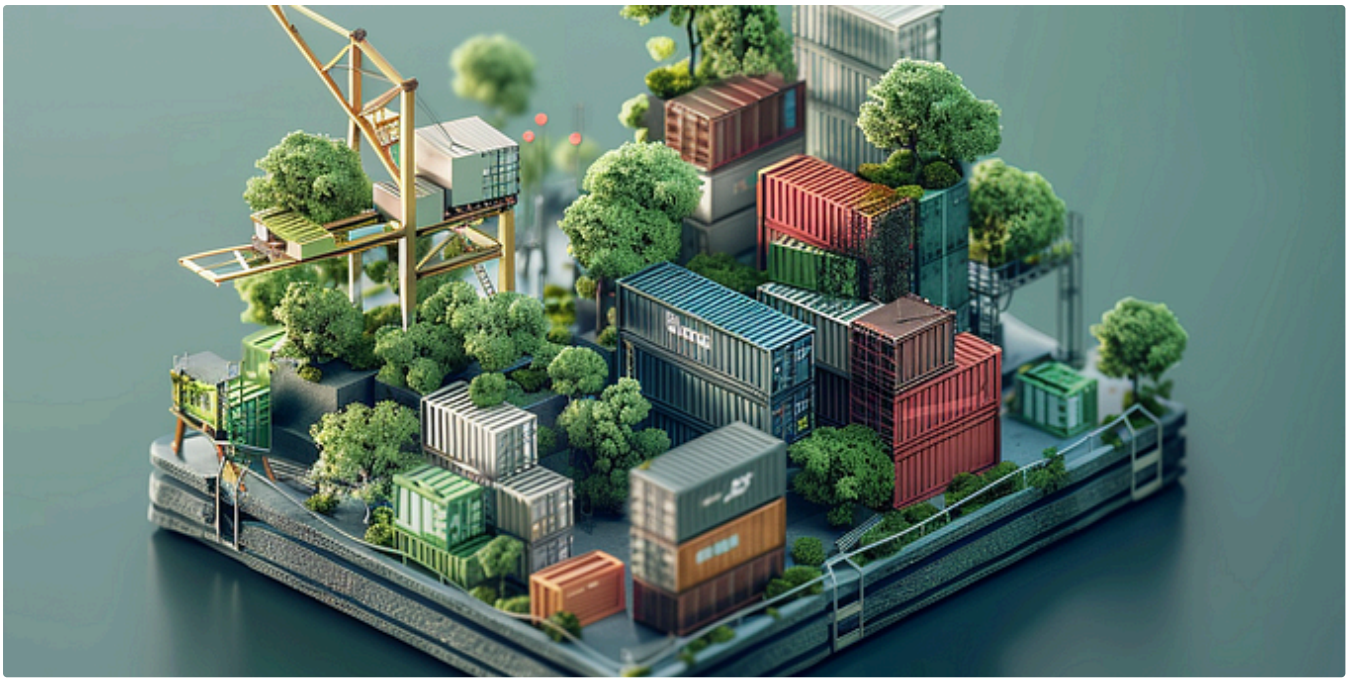
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